

Theme 2: Those Teenage Things

Goodbye to Childhood

Lesson 2-1
Book pages 17-19

💡 **Big idea:** **Adolescence** is the stage between childhood and adulthood (about **13 to 19**). It brings **physical** and **mental** changes, and new relationships with family and friends.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Identify the main ideas in a reading text
- Use language about adolescence
- Find words with similar meanings

📖 Key words

adolescence المراهقة	**transition** انتقال / تحول	**growth spurt** طفرة نمو	**hormone** هرمون
self-esteem تقدير الذات	**mood swings** تقلب المزاج	**peer pressure** ضغط الأقران	**conflict** خلاف

Physical changes

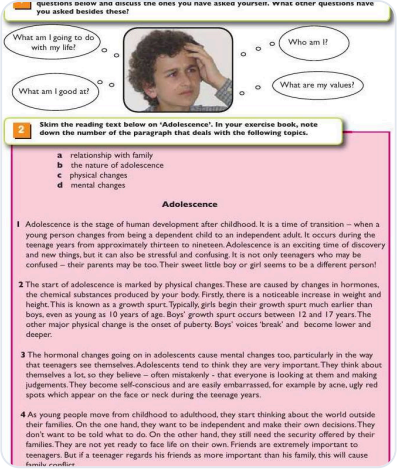
- Changes in hormones
- A growth spurt: a quick increase in height and weight
- Girls often begin their growth spurt earlier than boys

Mental changes

- Teenagers think they are very important
- They become self-conscious and easily embarrassed
- Mood swings are common

Family and friends

- Teens want independence but still need family support
- Friends become very important
- Choosing friends over family can cause family conflict


questions below and discuss the ones you have asked yourself. What other questions have you asked besides these?

What am I going to do with my life?

Who am I?

What am I good at?

What are my values?

2 Skim the reading text below on 'Adolescence'. In your exercise book, note down the number of the paragraph that deals with the following topics.

a relationship with family
b the nature of adolescence
c physical changes
d mental changes

Adolescence

1 Adolescence is the stage of human development after childhood. It is a time of transition – when a young person changes from being a dependent child to an independent adult. It occurs during the teenage years from approximately thirteen to nineteen. Adolescence is an exciting time of discovery and new things, but it can also be stressful and confusing. It is not only teenagers who may be confused – their parents may be too. Their sweet little boy or girl seems to be a different person!

2 The start of adolescence is marked by physical changes. These are caused by changes in hormones, the chemical substances produced by your body. Firstly, there is a noticeable increase in weight and height. This is known as a growth spurt. Typically, girls begin their growth spurt much earlier than boys, even as young as 10 years of age. Boys' growth spurt occurs between 12 and 17 years. The other major physical change is the onset of puberty. Boys' voices 'break' and become lower and deeper.

3 The hormonal changes going on in adolescents cause mental changes too, particularly in the way that teenagers see themselves. Adolescents tend to think they are very important. They think about themselves a lot, so they believe – often mistakenly – that everyone is looking at them and making judgements. They become self-conscious and are easily embarrassed, for example by acne, ugly red spots which appear on the face or neck during the teenage years.

4 As young people move from childhood to adulthood, they start thinking about the world outside their families. On the one hand, they want to be independent and make their own decisions. They don't want to be told what to do. On the other hand, they still need the security offered by their families. They are not yet ready to face life on their own. Friends are extremely important to teenagers. But if a teenager regards his friends as more important than his family, this will cause family conflict.

Reading: Adolescence (p.18)

✏️ Examples

What is a growth spurt?

Answer: A noticeable increase in weight and height during adolescence.

⭐ Remember

- To find the main ideas, read the first sentence of each paragraph.

⚠️ Watch out

- Adolescence is only about the body.
  → It also changes thinking, feelings and relationships.

🧩 **Activity:** Write three questions teenagers ask themselves and your answer to one of them.

✅ Check yourself

1. When does adolescence happen?
2. What is self-esteem?
3. What can cause family conflict?

Answers: (1) About 13 to 19 ، (2) Feeling you are a person of value ، (3) Choosing friends over family